

SOLE SOURCE JUSTIFICATION AND APPROVAL FOR ACQUISITION UNDER THE SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION THRESHOLD

1. Contracting Agency and Activity. The Department of the Interior, United States Geological Survey Reston Acquisitions Branch, Reston, VA, plans to contract on a sole source basis. This document sets forth the justification and approval as required by FAR 13.106-1(b)(1) "Only One Source Reasonable Available"

2. Nature of Action Being Approved. The USGS Eastern Ecological Science Center at Patuxent Research Refuge is requesting a sole source 3-year IDIQ for RNA Seq analysis of avian gut content, blood, and organ tissue samples to identify viruses and differentially expressed microbial and host genes in birds exposed to environmental contaminants to Genewiz, LLC.

3. Description of Supplies or Services. This RNA sequencing project requires RNA extraction from avian organ tissue, blood, and gut microbiome samples preserved in RNA later or DNA/RNA shield (supplied by USGS), polyA enrichment from total RNA derived from tissue and dual rRNA depletion from total RNA derived from microbiome, library preparation with the NEBNext Ultra II RNA kit, and sequencing on Illumina NovaSeq X Plus (or similar) platform with the sequencing depth of 60 million paired (120 million total) reads. The research requires a company that has sufficient sequencing capacity to allow for efficient turnaround time and high depth, high quality sequencing and delivery of data.

4. Estimated Dollar Value. \$150,000.00

5. Statutory Authority. The proposed action may be awarded on a sole source basis in accordance with: FAR 13.106-1(b)(1) "Only One Source Reasonable Available"

6. Rationale Supporting Use of Citation in No. 5. A competitive contract was awarded to Genewiz, LLC/140G0119P0369 to analyze RNA extracted from avian organ tissue. The most recent award to satisfy this requirement was made to Genewiz, LLC. 140G0121D0017, on a sole source basis citing that the continuity in long-term data set is essential to the research. The selection of a different laboratory for the sample analysis in this study would jeopardize the continuity of data by introducing variability in methodology, quality control, and analytical instrumentation.

7. Other Information. N/A

8. The Efforts to Identify Additional Sources Including the Market Research Conducted. Market research indicates no other vendor can provide the continuity with the analyses performed under the previous contract.

9. Future Plans to Permit Competition. Future requirements will undergo market research and be competed to the maximum extent practical.

10. Recommendation Program Office

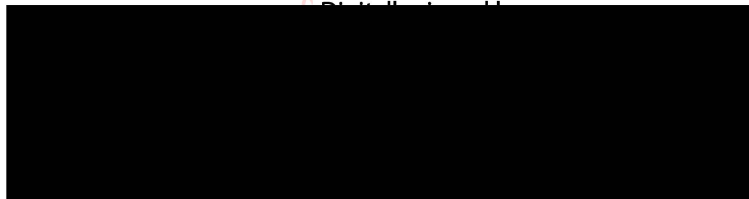
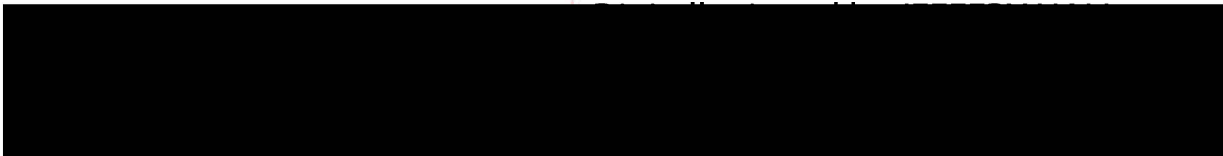
Based on the above, I recommend this acquisition be conducted on a sole source basis and certify that the above statements are true and correct.



11. Certifications from the Contracting Officer

- a. The price will be determined fair and reasonable based upon comparison to prices paid for the same services.
- b. This justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

12. Approvals



Date

PPI Blurb Justification

The U.S. Geological Survey (USGS) considers employee signatures to be Personal Protected Information, and therefore all employee signatures have been redacted. By posting this document, the Contracting Officer attests all appropriate signatures have been obtained.